PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Azure | Security Copilot | SIEM Engineering

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience securing enterprise environments using Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Azure, and the broader Microsoft security ecosystem. In my current role at the University of the Arts London, I design and implement detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), manage Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation playbooks to accelerate incident response, and oversee identity security controls in Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). I have strong experience protecting sensitive data and user identities across large, complex organisations, and I understand the critical importance of safeguarding client data, confidential information assets, and legal privilege in a professional services environment. I am experienced with Microsoft Security Copilot as an AI-driven force multiplier for security operations, and I am excited to bring my Microsoft cloud security engineering expertise to a forward-thinking legal organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection engineering, analytics rules, threat hunting workbooks, SOAR playbook development, Log Analytics workspace management, data connector onboarding
- **Microsoft Azure:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Azure Identity Protection, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Azure Policy, Azure Monitor
- **Microsoft Security Copilot:** AI-assisted threat investigation, incident summarisation, KQL generation, and security posture analysis
- **Microsoft Defender Platform:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Microsoft 365 Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR)
- **SIEM / SOAR / EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent / Insight / Discover; Splunk (SPL); SOAR automation and orchestration
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, MFA, SSO, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast (anti-phishing, anti-malware, Data Loss Prevention)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, root cause analysis
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR playbook logic
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design and engineer KQL (Kusto Query Language) analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, building detection coverage for identity-based attacks, data exfiltration, lateral movement, and privilege escalation mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Azure Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment, threat containment actions, and integrated ticketing workflows to accelerate incident response across an 8,000+ user estate.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) security posture, including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and identity risk investigations using Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI).

- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft 365 Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), configuring detection policies and investigating complex, multi-stage attack chains across endpoint and cloud surfaces.
- Leverage Microsoft Security Copilot for AI-assisted incident investigation, automated KQL generation, and rapid threat summarisation, improving analyst productivity during high-pressure incidents.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Falcon EDR modules (Prevent, Insight, Discover), ensuring comprehensive endpoint visibility and rapid threat containment.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to control, audit, and review privileged account access in line with least-privilege security principles.
- Administer Mimecast email security, tuning anti-phishing, anti-malware, and Data Loss Prevention (DLP) policies to protect against sophisticated email-borne threats.
- Lead vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams and tracking compliance against internal security standards.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, KQL, and the MITRE ATT&CK framework, identifying undetected threats before they escalate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored and investigated security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, triaging incidents and escalating complex cases through defined SOC procedures.
- Supported the deployment and operationalisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an estate of 8,000+ users.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) user identities, Conditional Access policies, and privileged role assignments, enforcing least-privilege principles.
- Wrote KQL queries for threat hunting, compliance reporting, and bespoke security dashboards in Microsoft Sentinel workbooks.
- Administered Mimecast email security platform and managed anti-phishing, DLP, and secure messaging policies to protect sensitive institutional data.
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance policies.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports aligned to CVSS scoring.
- Supported incident response activities following NIST 800-61, contributing to root cause analysis and post-incident improvement recommendations.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Administered Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and Microsoft 365 in a SaaS FinTech environment, managing identity and access controls for business-critical cloud services.
- Configured and maintained network and endpoint security controls, supporting ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance.
- Managed cloud infrastructure security, including Azure resource access controls, security group policies, and account lifecycle management.
- Supported information security risk assessments and contributed to vendor risk management and third-party security reviews.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across a 8,000+ user estate - the largest security platform rollout in UAL's history - delivering comprehensive Microsoft security coverage ahead of schedule.
- Authored over 20 KQL (Kusto Query Language) analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, significantly improving detection coverage for identity-based attacks, lateral movement, and data exfiltration.
- Developed a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SOAR automation framework, reducing mean time to respond to critical alerts by approximately 35%.

- Led successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification renewal for UAL, remediating over 150 identified vulnerabilities and demonstrating strong security posture to external auditors.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM across UAL, eliminating standing privileged access risks and delivering a complete privileged account audit trail.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)